

Climate change

Climate is the general weather conditions over a large area. It changes naturally over long periods of time. However, recently Earth's climate has been getting warmer faster than usual.

Polluted planet

Fossil fuels, such as oil and coal, are the buried remains of ancient plants and other living things. Burning them releases harmful gases, especially carbon dioxide (CO_2), into the air. These gases heat up and pollute our planet.



Motor vehicles

Cars and lorries use diesel and petrol as fuel. These fuels are made from oil. Burning them releases CO_2 into the air.

Carbon dioxide is called a "greenhouse gas" as it traps the Sun's energy in our atmosphere, heating the planet.

Factories

Over the last few hundred years, many coal-burning factories were built. They pumped more CO_2 into the atmosphere.



Chopping down forests

Trees soak up CO_2 like a big sponge. By chopping down forests for timber or to make farmland, we take away one of the best ways to remove CO_2 from the air.

